

Before a range of cells can be summarised, it should have proper column headers. It also needs to be sorted on all columns that will form the summary group. For example, to create a product-wise, monthly summary of the sales performance of the salesmen in an organisation, the data should not only be sorted on the name of the salesman, but also on the month and product name. In this case, what you need is a multi-level sort.

The Tools to summarise data are available under the Outline block under the Data Tab. After the sorting is complete, you select a cell in the range and click on the Subtotal Button. This will open a window listing the various summarising options. The column whose value is to be used as the key needs to be identified under the “At each Change in” field.

Besides Sum, other summarising operations like Count, Average, Maximum, etc. are also provided under the Use Function field. The columns which need to be given a subtotal row can also be selected. You can also choose whether to display the summary data below or above the data. The result of performing a Subtotal routine is that a row is inserted, at every change in the value in the Summary column, which will carry the results of the chosen summary operation. A final grand total row is inserted at the end of the cell range carrying the summary figures for the entire range.



Summarise options

When the Subtotal process is complete, the Group controls make an appearance on the Left Margin. The use and significance of these controls have already been described in the previous section. If the Group controls are not needed, the Clear Outline link under the Ungroup button can be used. To re-apply the controls, use the Auto Outline option under the Group button.